

VA BUSINESS BLUEPRINT

From Zero Leads to Fully Booked — Fast

AI & Automation

Media Editing

Social Media

24/7 Premium

Target Rate: \$25 / hour

Platforms: Upwork | Fiverr | LinkedIn | Instagram | X | Cold Outreach

Daily Investment: 3-5 Hours | Goal: First client within 7-14 days

11 Sections

**30-Day
Roadmap**

**Scripts
Included**

**\$0 Required
to Start**

1. YOUR VA BUSINESS AT A GLANCE

WHO YOU ARE

You are a Tech-Powered Virtual Assistant specialising in AI configuration, media production, and social media strategy. You offer 24/7 availability to clients who need always-on execution — not a 9-to-5 freelancer.

Your Core Service Pillars

AI & AUTOMATION	MEDIA PRODUCTION
AI & Automation Services	Media Production Services
JSON prompt engineering	Photo editing & retouching
LLM API configuration	Video editing (short & long form)
Workflow automation (Zapier/Make)	Thumbnail / graphic design
AI chatbot setup & training	Brand visual kits
System prompt architecture	Reels / TikTok / YT content

SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT	ADD-ON SERVICES
Social Media Management	Add-On / Bundled Services
Content calendar creation	Email management & drafting
Scheduling & publishing	Research & lead generation
Analytics & reporting	Data entry & organisation
Engagement management	CRM updates & pipeline mgmt
Hashtag & growth strategy	Presentation decks (PPT/Canva)

Pricing Structure

Start at \$25/hr and package upwards. Recommended rate card:

Package	Price	Best For
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Hourly (flexible)	\$25/hr	Project work, testing the relationship
Starter Pack (20 hrs/mo)	\$480/mo	Small businesses, solopreneurs
Growth Pack (40 hrs/mo)	\$940/mo	Agencies, coaches, e-commerce
Premium 24/7 (80 hrs/mo)	\$1,800/mo	High-demand clients, full coverage
Project-Based (AI setup)	From \$150 flat	One-time builds, editing packages

2. PORTFOLIO SETUP (Days 1–3)

GOAL

Turn your existing skills into a visible, credible portfolio that makes clients say 'yes' before they even contact you. Every hour you invest here pays back in easier closes.

Step 1 — Define Your Portfolio Structure

Your portfolio must contain 5 sections. You already have profiles — this is about upgrading, not starting over:

- Hero Statement — who you are + what you offer in 2 sentences
- Service Menu — clear packages with prices or 'starting from' rates
- Work Samples — minimum 6 pieces (2 per niche)
- Process & Tools — show your tech stack; this builds instant trust with technical clients
- Testimonials / Social Proof — even placeholder if new (see below)

Step 2 — Create Your Work Samples

AI & Automation Samples

- Build a sample JSON prompt system for a fictional brand (e.g. e-commerce chatbot)
- Screen-record an API configuration walkthrough (OpenAI, Anthropic, or Make.com)
- Create a Notion or Loom walkthrough of a workflow you built
- Write a 1-page 'AI Strategy Brief' for a fictional client niche

Media Editing Samples

- Edit 2–3 short-form videos (under 60s) using your own footage or royalty-free stock
- Create 3–5 before/after photo edits — document the transformation clearly
- Design 2 YouTube thumbnails and 2 Instagram carousel posts
- Build a Canva-style brand kit mockup for a fictional brand

Social Media Management Samples

- Create a sample 30-day content calendar for a niche (fitness, e-commerce, coaching)
- Screenshot a sample analytics report (mock one professionally in Canva / Data Studio)
- Write 5 sample post captions with hashtag strategy across 2 platforms

Step 3 — Build Your Portfolio Hub

You need ONE central link as your portfolio. Options ranked by speed:

Option	Platform	Build Time	Recommended
Notion Portfolio	Notion.so (free)	2–3 hours	YES — Fastest
Carrd Website	Carrd.co (\$9/yr)	3–4 hours	YES — Most Pro
LinkedIn Profile	linkedin.com (free)	1–2 hours	YES — Run Both
Behance / Dribbble	Design/media only	2–3 hours	Optional add-on

ACTION

Build your Carrd site AND LinkedIn simultaneously. Carrd = your visual portfolio link you send everywhere. LinkedIn = your SEO-powered inbound machine. Both in 6 hours total.

Step 4 — Carrd Portfolio Page Layout

1. Header: Your name, title, location, and a 'Book a Free Call' button
2. About: 3–4 sentence bio focusing on outcomes you deliver, not just tools you know
3. Services: 3 clear cards — AI/Automation | Media Production | Social Media Mgmt
4. Portfolio Grid: 6+ clickable samples with brief descriptions
5. Tech Stack: List all tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Premiere Pro, Canva, Later, Hootsuite, Make.com, Zapier...)
6. Testimonials: LinkedIn recommendations or course completion certificates work early on
7. CTA: Calendly link or contact form — make it easy to say yes

3. PLATFORM PROFILE OPTIMISATION (Days 2–5)

UPWORK — Your Primary Income Platform

WHY UPWORK FIRST

Upwork has buyers actively searching and ready to pay. It is the fastest path to your first \$25/hr booking.

Profile Checklist

- Profile photo: Professional, well-lit, plain background, direct eye contact
- Title: 'AI Systems & Media Virtual Assistant | 24/7 Availability | \$25/hr'
- Overview (first 2 lines CRITICAL): Lead with a problem you solve, not your CV. Example: 'Busy founders lose 20+ hours/week to content, admin, and tech setup. I eliminate that.'
- Specialised profiles: Create 3 specialised profiles — one per niche (Upwork allows this)
- Skills: Tag AI tools, video editing software, social media platforms specifically
- Portfolio: Upload all work samples directly — visual proof converts best
- Certifications: Add free certs (Google, Meta, HubSpot) before launching
- Availability badge: Turn on '24/7 availability' — your key differentiator

Winning Proposal Formula

THE 150-WORD PROPOSAL

Line 1: Name ONE specific problem you noticed in their job post.

Line 2: Briefly explain exactly how you solve it.

Line 3: Attach 1 relevant sample or case study.

Line 4: Ask ONE specific question about their project.

Line 5: Short CTA — 'Can we jump on a 15-min call this week?'

Target: under 150 words. Long proposals get skipped.

Upwork Job Categories to Target

- Virtual Assistant (AI/Tech focus)
- Social Media Manager
- Video Editor
- AI Prompt Engineer / LLM Specialist
- Automation Specialist (Zapier, Make)
- Content Creator / Social Media Strategist

FIVERR — Your Passive Lead Machine

Create These 5 Gigs

1. 'I will set up your AI chatbot with custom JSON prompts' — Starting \$75
2. 'I will edit your short-form video for Instagram and TikTok' — Starting \$35
3. 'I will manage your social media for one week (full service)' — Starting \$120
4. 'I will configure your AI workflow using APIs and automation tools' — Starting \$150
5. 'I will be your virtual assistant for 10 hours' — Starting \$200 (\$20/hr gateway)

Fiverr Optimisation Tips

- Thumbnail: Bold, clear graphic (Canva) — your editing skills are proof here
- Gig title: Use keywords people search (use Fiverr's search autocomplete for ideas)
- FAQ section: Answer the top 5 objections before clients ask them
- Fast delivery: Offer 24–48hr on at least 2 gigs to rank higher in search
- Video intro: Record a 30-second gig video — gigs with videos get 220% more orders

LINKEDIN — Your Professional Inbound Engine

Profile Overhaul

- Headline: 'Virtual Assistant | AI Configuration & Automation | Video & Photo Editing | Social Media Strategy | 24/7 Availability'
- Banner image: Create a professional banner in Canva showing your 3 service pillars
- About section: Tell a story — why you do this, who you help, what results they get
- Featured section: Pin your Carrd link, a sample project, and a testimonial
- Services section: Enable and list all services with keywords
- Experience: Add 'Freelance Virtual Assistant' as your current role

LinkedIn DM Script

OUTREACH MESSAGE

Hi [Name], I noticed you're building [their niche/business] — impressive work! I specialise in AI automation + social media as a virtual assistant, and I help businesses like yours free up 15–20 hrs/week. Would a quick 15-min chat be valuable? No pitch, just exploring if there's a fit.

4. SOCIAL MEDIA LEAD GENERATION (Days 3–14)

Instagram Strategy

Account Setup

- Switch to Creator or Business account
- Bio: 'AI-Powered VA | Video + Photo + Social Media | 24/7 Available | Book below'
- Link in bio: Your Carrd portfolio URL
- Profile photo: Same shot as Upwork/LinkedIn — consistency builds trust

Content Pillars (Post 4–5x/week)

1. Skill showcase: Time-lapses or reels of your editing work
2. Tips & value: '3 things my AI setup does for my clients every morning'
3. Behind the scenes: Your workflow, tools, setup
4. Social proof: Client wins, project completions, testimonials
5. Personality: Show who you are — people hire people, not profiles

X (Twitter) Strategy

- Tweet 2x daily: one value tweet (tip/insight) + one engagement tweet (reply to trending)
- Thread weekly: 'How I built an AI prompt system for a client in 2 hours' — these go viral in the tech niche
- Search keywords daily: 'need virtual assistant', 'looking for VA', 'hire social media manager', 'need video editor'
- Use Advanced Search to find tweets from the last 24 hours in your niche

TikTok Strategy (High ROI)

- Post 1 video/day: Short tutorials, before/after edits, AI tool demos
- Your editing skills = incredible TikTok content — use them to market your editing
- Hook formula: '3 things I do as an AI VA that no one else offers...'
- TikTok's algorithm favours new creators — fastest organic reach right now

5. COLD OUTREACH SYSTEM (Days 5–30+)

COLD OUTREACH TRUTH

Cold outreach is uncomfortable but it is the fastest way to land a client at \$25/hr. One good email campaign to 50 targeted prospects will get you 3–8 responses and 1–2 booked calls.

Ideal Client Profiles

- Solo coaches / consultants doing \$5k–\$20k/month (need VA but not a full team)
- Small agencies (5–20 people) that outsource overflow work
- E-commerce brands on Shopify/Etsy needing content + social
- Tech startups with small teams needing AI/automation support
- YouTube creators / podcasters needing editing + social clipping

Where to Find Clients

- LinkedIn Sales Navigator (free trial) — filter by company size, role, industry
- Apollo.io (free tier) — build lead lists with verified emails
- Twitter/X — search 'my VA just quit' or 'need to hire someone for...'
- Facebook Groups — 'Online Business Owners', 'Coaches Who Scale', VA hiring groups
- Reddit — r/entrepreneur, r/smallbusiness — read posts and DM those asking for help

Cold Email Template

COPY & SEND THIS

Subject: Quick question about [their company/content]

Hi [First Name],

I came across your [podcast/Instagram/business] and noticed you're doing [specific thing].

I'm a virtual assistant specialising in AI automation, video editing, and social media strategy. I help [client type] save 15–20 hours per week by handling their [specific pain point].

I put together a quick idea for how I could help [their company] specifically — want me to send it over?
Takes 2 minutes to read.

[Your Name] | [Portfolio URL] | [Calendly link]

P.S. I offer 24/7 availability, which means your projects never have to wait.

Daily Outreach Targets

- Send 10 personalised cold emails per day
- Send 5–10 LinkedIn connection requests with a personalised note

- Comment on 10 Instagram/X posts of target clients
- Follow up once, 3 days after initial outreach (50% of replies come from follow-ups)

6. EXECUTION TIMELINE

PHASE 1: PORTFOLIO & PLATFORM SETUP		Days 1–3
Day	Tasks	Time
Day 1	Create 3–5 work samples (1 per niche). Set up Carrd portfolio site. Register domain if needed.	3–5 hrs
Day 2	Optimise Upwork profile fully. Create 3 Fiverr gigs. Upload all portfolio samples.	4–5 hrs
Day 3	Overhaul LinkedIn (headline, banner, about, featured). Set up Instagram + X.	3–4 hrs

PHASE 2: ACTIVE OUTREACH LAUNCH		Days 4–7
Day	Tasks	Time
Day 4	Send first 8 Upwork proposals. Build cold email list of 30 targets. Post first Instagram content.	4–5 hrs
Day 5	Send 10 proposals on Upwork. Send 10 cold emails. LinkedIn: 10 connection requests.	4–5 hrs
Day 6	Follow up on Day 4 Upwork proposals. Continue cold email. Post on Instagram + X.	3–4 hrs
Day 7	Review what is working. Tweak proposals if no responses. Set up Calendly for discovery calls.	3–4 hrs

PHASE 3: MOMENTUM & FIRST CLIENT	Days 8–14
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- Continue 10 Upwork proposals/day — focus on jobs posted within last 24 hours
- Scale cold email to 15/day — follow up on all week 1 sends
- Engage in 3 LinkedIn/X posts daily in your target client's niche
- Publish first TikTok/Reels video showcasing your work
- Book at least 2 discovery calls — treat these as practice, not pressure

- If no Upwork interviews by Day 10: lower first gig to \$18-20/hr for 1 project to get your first review, then raise it back

FIRST CLIENT GOAL

Your only goal in week 2 is to get ONE paid project — even a small one. A single 5-star review on Upwork changes your conversion rate permanently. Lower the price barrier if needed, then raise it.

PHASE 4: SCALE & RECURRING REVENUE

Days 15–30+

- Turn your first client into a retainer — pitch a monthly package after delivering great work
- Ask for a testimonial and LinkedIn recommendation within 48 hours of project completion
- Raise Upwork rate to \$25/hr once you have 2+ reviews
- Start a weekly email newsletter to your LinkedIn connections sharing AI/VA tips
- Productise one service into a fixed Fiverr package to generate passive inquiries
- Target: 2 retainer clients at \$500+/mo each = \$1,000 MRR by Day 30

7. YOUR DAILY 3–5 HOUR SCHEDULE

Time Block	Activity	Why It Matters
Block 1 (45 min)	Check & respond to all messages, proposals, DMs	Speed of response wins clients
Block 2 (60 min)	Send 5–8 Upwork proposals (fresh jobs only)	Highest ROI activity in early stage
Block 3 (45 min)	Cold email / LinkedIn outreach (10 messages)	Builds pipeline outside Upwork
Block 4 (45 min)	Create + schedule 1 piece of social content	Long-term inbound lead generation
Block 5 (30 min)	Engage on LinkedIn/X (10 comments on target accounts)	Visibility & relationship building
Block 6 (15 min)	Track metrics in your lead tracker	Data drives better decisions

8. TOOLS & TECH STACK

FREE TOOLS	LOW-COST TOOLS (\$5–20/mo)
FREE TOOLS	PAID TOOLS (optional)
Canva — graphics & presentations	Carrd.co — portfolio site (\$9/yr)
Notion — portfolio & CRM tracker	Zoho Mail — professional email (\$1/mo)
Calendly — booking discovery calls	CapCut Pro — advanced video editing
Apollo.io (free) — lead lists	Descript — AI video/audio editing
HubSpot Free — email CRM	ChatGPT Plus — AI work (\$20/mo)
Loom — async video walkthroughs	Claude.ai Pro — AI config (\$20/mo)
Buffer / Later (free) — scheduling	Zapier Starter — automation (\$20/mo)

9. KPIs & SUCCESS METRICS

WEEKLY ACTIVITY TARGETS	30-DAY FINANCIAL TARGETS
WEEKLY TARGETS	30-DAY GOALS
Upwork proposals sent: 50+	First paid project: Week 2
Cold emails sent: 70+	First 5-star Upwork review: Week 2–3
LinkedIn connections: 50+	Monthly recurring revenue: \$500+
Social posts published: 4–5	Active clients: 2–3
Discovery calls booked: 2+	Average project value: \$200+
Proposal response rate: 10%+	Hourly rate achieved: \$22–25/hr

10. DISCOVERY CALL & OBJECTION HANDLING

Your Discovery Call Framework (15–20 min)

1. Open: 'Tell me about your business and what you are currently spending most of your time on.'
2. Dig: 'What happens if that problem is not solved in the next 90 days?'
3. Value: 'Based on what you have told me, here is exactly how I would help you...'
4. Offer: Present your most relevant package — lead with outcomes, not hours
5. Close: 'Does this sound like it would solve the problem? Shall we get started this week?'

Handling Common Objections

"Your rate is too high"

Response: 'I understand budget is a consideration. What I can offer is a 5-hour trial project at a discounted rate so you can see the value before committing. Most clients find they save more in time than they spend in fees.'

"I need someone with more experience"

Response: 'Here are 3 samples directly relevant to your project. I would also offer a 100% satisfaction guarantee on our first project — if you are not happy with the output, I will redo it at no charge.'

"I need to think about it"

Response: 'Completely fair! What is the one thing holding you back? I want to make sure I have answered every concern before you decide.' Then listen and address it directly.

11. QUICK-START CHECKLIST

Print this and tick each item off as you complete it:

Days 1–3: Foundation

- Create 6 work samples (2 per niche)
- Build Carrd portfolio site with all sections
- Optimise Upwork profile completely
- Create 3 Fiverr gigs

- Overhaul LinkedIn profile
- Set up professional email
- Set up Calendly for booking calls

Days 4–7: Launch

- Send 8–10 Upwork proposals daily
- Send 10 cold emails daily
- Post daily on Instagram and X
- Send 10 LinkedIn connection requests daily
- Set up lead tracker in Notion / Google Sheets

Days 8–14: Momentum

- Follow up on all week 1 outreach
- Book and conduct first 2 discovery calls
- Land first paid project (lower price if needed for first review)
- Request testimonial immediately after delivery

Days 15–30: Scale

- Raise Upwork rate to \$25/hr after first review
- Pitch retainer to first client
- Publish first long-form LinkedIn article
- Start weekly newsletter to connections
- Target: 2 retainer clients, \$1,000 MRR

FINAL WORD

Speed beats perfection. Your portfolio does not need to be perfect on Day 1 — it needs to exist. Your proposals do not need to be flawless — they need to be sent. The fastest path to \$25/hr is consistent daily action. 3–5 hours every day for 30 days will completely transform your client pipeline. Start today.

Built for your success. Now go execute.